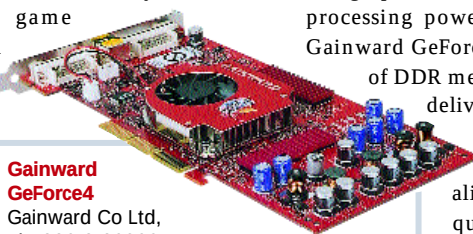


3D GRAPHICS

Ardent gamers are not used to settling for anything lower than the best when it comes to their favourite games, be it a first person shooter or a racing simulation. But at the rate that graphics technology advances, what's hot today is stone cold a few months down the line. This year has seen some of the most formidable technologies, where more pipelines, and faster core and memory speeds have allowed cards such as nVidia's GeForce4 and ATI's Radeon 9700 to blur the line between high performance gaming and cinema-like graphics.

Behind the polygons

Forthcoming games will use larger, more detailed textures. Game developers are already going all-out in creating high-polygon count models and game characters. These games will demand Programmable Pixels, at least 64 MB of DDR video memory and of course, faster core and memory speeds. Programmable GPUs allow game developers to create custom effects in models and environments—all this spells the need for the fastest video memory you can afford on your graphics card and faster AGP interfaces such as AGP 8x. Also remember that you will need a powerful system processor to run these graphics powerhouses.



Gainward GeForce4
Gainward Co Ltd,
Ph: 886-2-26966777

The verdict: This card has a massive 300 MHz core and 640 MHz of DDR memory. It shattered all record on our gaming benchmarks, proving to be the fastest vehicle for a killer gaming experience!

Nominees

Name	Contacts	Comments
GeForce4 Ti 4600	Xserve India Pvt Ltd, Ph: 080-5202915	This GeForce4-based card has a massive amount of DDR memory. It logged a commendable score in our gaming benchmarks, making it an ideal choice to a fast gaming system
GeForce4 Ti 4200	Xserve India Pvt Ltd, Ph: 080-5202915	With a 250 MHz core and a memory speed, this 64 MB DDR memory-based card packs the power to get you through your gaming escapades comfortably

These factors will ensure that you won't have to live your first *DOOM 3* experience like it was a slideshow!

And the award goes to...

The graphics card that impressed us this year with its best processing power and stunning frame rates in games was the Gainward GeForce4. Sporting a 300 MHz core speed and 640 MB of DDR memory (effectively running at 640 MHz), it delivered the highest frame rates we have ever seen in gaming: in *Quake III Arena*, even with resolution cranked up to 1024x768, with 32-bit texture depth and with quality settings kept at their maximum value, this card pushed out over 100 fps on a test system comprising of a 2.8 GHz Pentium 4 processor. With this card, you will be able to enjoy the latest games at butter-smooth frame rates without sacrificing graphics quality.

GAMES

Unreal Tournament 2003

Smoke streaming through floor gratings, a flickering blue light reflecting off a steel door, rusted girders looming through a murky corridor—*Unreal Tournament 2003* is the path-breaking game that set new standards for realism in 3D gaming. It sports a radically new game engine that allows for an intensive level of detail and environmental splendour, which can be enjoyed even on a mid-range machine without slowing down to a slideshow. Retaining all the classic elements of a winning First Person Shooter, the game has vast and playable levels, radical weaponry and modes of gameplay to keep an enthusiast riveted for hours. It also features one of the most realistic physics engines where bodies and elements move and react to external stimulus more realistically.

Incorporating a very powerful set of level editing and creation tools, the playability and the level of variation in this game can be supplemented with user-created add-ons and enhancements, ensuring that *Tournament 2003*, like its predecessor, will continue to have a long life.



Unreal Tournament 2003
Milestone
Interactive Software,
Ph: 022-28381614

The verdict: With a new game engine that allows greater detail, *Unreal Tournament 2003* sets new standards for realism

